

affect their finances, such as the learned female tendency to have a scarcity mindset where they don't think they're enough. Perhaps it's that they're not good enough, not thin enough, not smart enough, not pretty enough, not talented enough, not safe enough, not certain enough, not fit enough, not from the right school or the right suburb. Or maybe it's that they believe they're not a good enough mother/friend/ sister/girlfriend/wife. I'm sure many women can add their own version here.

Now, for blokes reading along, no doubt you're thinking this is exhausting and can I emphatically say that it is. As someone who has lived with many of these voices over the years, it's bloody draining. The problem for many women is that not being enough is such an ingrained story that we don't even think to recognise or question it—because it's not a conscious thought; it's background noise from the moment we wake to the moment we sleep.

Add this not enough belief to scarcity mentality and to a comparison culture, where we're comparing ourselves not just to our neighbours but to social media influencer freebie-receiving, face-tuned images of perfection, and it can create a toxic cocktail that sets us up for failure.

It's a message that we as women have received from our external environment and sadly for too many it's a case of 'received and understood'. In other words, we receive scarcity because we believe our Money Story that we're not enough.

Don't believe me? Let's look at one example of an area where women should be on par with men: our own businesses. Yet a 2015 Australian Bureau of Statistics study reported that women in business earn almost \$500 less than men in business per week. That's over \$25,000 per year. Now, women running their own businesses and setting their own prices should be an area where they achieve parity. But they're not, because pricing is a part of business that so many women suck at. (I'm saying this with so much love because I've done it myself.) Pricing a product or service often makes women feel they're 'valuing themselves' and when that pervasive 'not enough' mentality creeps in it can affect how they set their businesses' prices. That means women in business not only earn less than men in business, but they also earn less than women in corporate roles.

Added to this, too often I hear women refer to their business as 'my baby' or say it's 'just a home business' or 'just a part-time business'. These